COMMUNITY CLINIC REPORTING

Care in Action

User guide

Turn the activity you already track into a clear, benchmark-based estimate of its value.

1 Prepare — 2 Enter details — 3 Add activity — 4 Review — 5 Export

What this tool helps you do

Care in Action estimates the value of clinical services provided **or** volunteer hours contributed. Use the summary to support grant applications, donor and board updates, annual reports, and conversations with community partners.

Gather your information

Use totals for one reporting period. Have these ready:

- **Clinic name and full address.**
- **Reporting period:** start and end dates.
- **One activity type:** total volunteer hours by role **or** total clinical service counts by service.
- **Optional:** total clinic cost for the same reporting period.

Privacy rule

Use aggregate totals only. **Do not enter patient names, medical records, patient identifiers, or other patient-level information.**

Find what you need

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Set up your report

1. Start the estimator

Read the welcome screen and its **What you'll need** information. Select **Begin**.

2. Enter clinic information

Field	What to enter
Clinic name and address	Enter the clinic name, street address, and city.
State	Use a valid two-letter U.S. state or District of Columbia abbreviation.
ZIP code	Use a five-digit ZIP code or ZIP+4.
Reporting period	Choose both dates. The start date must be on or before the end date.
Total clinic cost (optional)	Enter only if available. Use total clinic cost for the same reporting period.

Select **Next**. If a required field needs attention, follow the message beside it.

Keep the reporting period consistent

Use dates and activity totals from the same period. The ZIP code identifies the clinic in the report; it **does not adjust reference rates** for local costs or location.

3. Choose one calculation method

Volunteer hours	Clinical services
Estimate the replacement value of donated time by volunteer role.	Estimate the value of reported clinical services using reference rates.

Choose only one method per report. Hours and service counts are not combined. If you switch methods after entering activity, the estimator warns that entries for the other method will be cleared.

Enter activity totals

4. Add roles or services

• Use the **search field** to find a volunteer role or clinical service.

• Enter its total for the full reporting period.

• Select **Add another** to add a row. Use a row's remove button to remove that row.

• Enter each role or service **only once**. Combine repeated activity into one total.

Entry rule	Volunteer hours	Clinical services
What to count	Hours contributed by role	Number of services provided
Allowed values	Zero or greater, in half-hour increments	Zero or greater, as whole numbers
Valid examples	12 or 12.5 hours	25 services
Not valid	12.25 hours; negative hours	2.5 services; negative counts

Required to create a summary

At least **one activity entry must be greater than zero**. A report with only zero values cannot produce a summary.

Check your entries

• Every row has a selected role or service and a valid number.

• There are no duplicate roles or services.

• Totals match your records and the reporting period.

Select **See impact summary**. If the estimator flags an incomplete or invalid row, correct it before continuing.

Use totals, not individual records

Do not enter patient names, medical record numbers, or details about individual patients.

Review and interpret

5. Review the impact summary

The summary shows the estimated value for your selected method, activity totals, and available breakdowns. Depending on the method and entries, it may also show rates, source references, rankings, a suggested impact statement, and an optional clinic-cost comparison.

- Verify the **clinic name, address, reporting dates, method, and activity totals**.
- Check the **rate sources and rate year** shown in the report.
- Review and adapt the suggested statement to your organization's context.

How the estimate works

Volunteer estimate

Hours by role **×;** hourly reference rate **=** estimated value

Clinical-services estimate

Counts by service **×;** service reference rate **=** estimated value

Each role or service uses its own reference rate. The total combines values within your selected method.

An estimate, not a financial or clinical outcome

Results are for **planning and communication**. They are not clinic revenue, charges, reimbursement, profit, confirmed savings, financial return on investment (ROI), patient outcomes, or a measure of care quality.

Understand the reference rates

Rates are embedded and **not refreshed live**. Volunteer estimates reference U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics data and Independent Sector's Value of Volunteer Time. Clinical-service rates use CMS Physician Fee Schedule information. Review the report's sources and rate year before external use.

If you entered clinic cost

The summary may compare reported clinic cost with estimated activity value. This is informational, **not actual financial ROI or confirmed healthcare savings**. The estimate does not account for every cost, service, or outcome.

Keep a copy of your report

Save before you leave

The estimator has **no save-and-resume feature**. Entries and the report remain in the current page's memory only. Refreshing or closing the page discards them.

Copy the suggested statement

• On the summary screen, select **Copy impact statement**.

• Paste the text into your document or message.

• Review and edit it before sharing. Explain that the result is a **benchmark-based estimate**.

Print or save a PDF

• Select **Download PDF report** to open a print-ready report.

• In the browser's print dialog, choose a printer or **Save as PDF**.

• If the window does not open, allow pop-ups for the site and select the PDF button again.

Download an Excel workbook

• Select **Download Excel workbook**.

• Keep the downloaded workbook with your reporting records.

• If the download fails, the workbook library may not have loaded. Try again with an internet connection or contact the tool administrator.

Where your copy goes

Downloaded reports and copied text are saved or pasted wherever you choose. They are **not stored by the estimator for a later session**.

Use the report thoughtfully

Care in Action is a communication aid, not a substitute for your clinic's records or professional judgment. Verify totals, rate sources, and reporting dates before sharing.

QUICK REFERENCE

Troubleshoot and check

If this happens	What to do
A field shows an error	Read the message beside the field. Check required clinic details, dates, state abbreviation, ZIP code, and numbers.
Reporting period is rejected	Enter valid start and end dates. The start date must not be after the end date.
An activity row is rejected	Select a role or service and enter a non-negative number. Use half-hour increments for hours and whole numbers for service counts. Enter each role or service only once.
No summary appears	Confirm at least one activity total is greater than zero and all rows are complete and valid.
PDF window does not open	Allow pop-ups for the site, then select Download PDF report again.
Excel download does not work	Check your internet connection and try again. The workbook library may not have loaded. If needed, contact the tool administrator.
The page reloads or closes	Unfinished reports cannot be restored by the estimator. Re-enter information from your own records.

Final check before sharing

- No test or sample data appears in the report.
- Clinic details, method, dates, and totals are correct.
- Rate sources and rate year have been reviewed.
- The statement identifies the result as an estimate, not revenue, ROI, or confirmed savings.
- Your report or statement has been downloaded or copied.

Need help?

Contact your tool administrator if you cannot confirm whether data is sample data, need the production version, or cannot resolve a download problem.